

Joint Force Requirements Process (JFRP)

TOPIC LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Upon successful completion of this topic, the student will be able to:

1. Recognize the interface between the Warfighting Acquisition System (WAS) and the Joint Force Requirements Process (JFRP) and identify the governing documents.
2. Recognize the importance of the Capability Gap Assessment.
3. Understand why the JFRP was established.
4. Recognize the purpose of user-developed capability documents and the correlating phase of the acquisition system.
5. Identify and describe the 5 core components of the JFRP.
6. Recognize the importance and priority of exploring materiel and non-materiel solutions.
7. Identify the role of the Joint Requirements Oversight Council (JROC).
8. Identify the aspects of the JFRP as it applies to acquisition of Information Technology (e.g., Net-Ready, interoperability, architecture, reuse).
9. Recognize why Command, Control, Communications, Computers, and Intelligence (C4I) interoperability must be considered with all affected U.S. and Allied systems.
10. Recognize the user's (Warfighter's) role and tools in identifying capability deficiencies.

STUDENT PREPARATION

Student Support Material

1. None

Primary References

1. CJCSI 5123.01 Series, Charter of the Joint Requirement Oversight Council (JROC) and Implementation of the Joint Force Requirements Process.
2. CJCSM 5123.01A Series, Manual for the Joint Requirements Oversight Council and the Joint Force Requirements Process
3. DoD and SECNAV 5000 Series

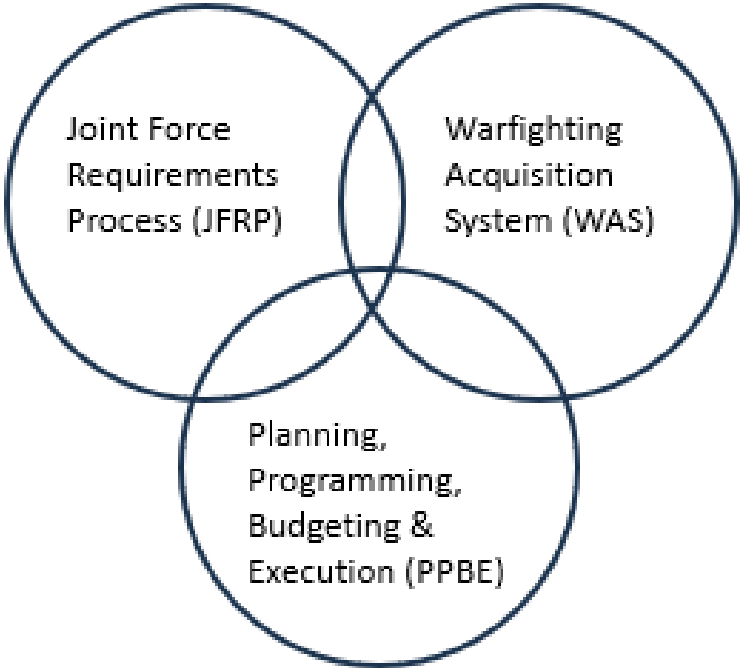
Additional References

1. https://cdnapisec.kaltura.com/index.php/extwidget/preview/partner_id/2203981/uiconf_id/54104082/entry_id/1_m2p5fpa1/embed/dynamic

Overview

- Introduction
- Establishment of JFRP
- Capability Gap Assessment
- Capability Documents
- Key Players in the Process
- Joint Requirements and Resourcing Theory of Victory

Decision Support Systems



- **JFRP – Requirements (Warfighters)**
- **PPBE – Money (Funding stakeholders)**
- **WAS– Materiel (Adaptive Acquisition Framework)**

The three decision support systems operate continuously and must interface on a regular basis to enable DoW leadership to make informed decisions

Why do we need JFRP?

- Primary objective of JFRP:
  - To ensure the Joint Warfighter receives the capabilities required to successfully execute the missions assigned to them
    - Capability = the ability to achieve an objective in a military operation
    - Requirements identified through JFRP can be either materiel or non-materiel
  - Institutionalize a Joint capability or service specific need requiring a materiel solution
  - Initiate the acquisition management process

DoW defines and validates requirements through the JFRP

Overview

- Introduction
- Establishment of JFRP
- Capability Gap Assessment
- Capability Documents
- Key Players in the Process
- Joint Requirements and Resourcing Theory of Victory

Establishment of JFRP

- A major transformation occurred when the Joint Staff rescinded the old requirement system, the Joint Capability Integration & Development System (JCIDS) on 15JAN2026
- Services were given full authority to approve and certify their own service requirements
  - Prior to this, Major Defense Acquisition Program (MDAP) requirements definition, validation, and approval was owned by the Joint Requirements Oversight Council (JROC)
- No standardized document supporting acquisition exists at the component level
- Each service is permitted to change staffing, approval policies, and naming conventions of these documents
- While ICDs and CDDs may still exist, services may change their names
  - May generically be referred to as a Service Requirements Document (SRD)

JFRP delegates Service requirements validation authority to the Component Level to accelerate identification of the capability need

Establishment of JFRP (cont.)

- This change from JCIDS to JFRP, detailed in CJCSI 5123.01J and its accompanying manual, CJCSM 5123.01A, is designed to accelerate the delivery of capabilities to the warfighter by:
  - Cutting red tape
  - Empowering the military services
  - Creating a clearer path from strategic priorities to fielded solutions

- The primary driver for this update was the recognition that the previous JCIDS process was too slow and bureaucratic, often hindering rapid capability development

- JFRP is built on the following guiding principles:
  - Deliver capability at speed
  - Preserve the independent warfighter voice
  - Ensure alignment from strategy to budget with analytic due diligence
  - Drive Joint Force design, development, and integration

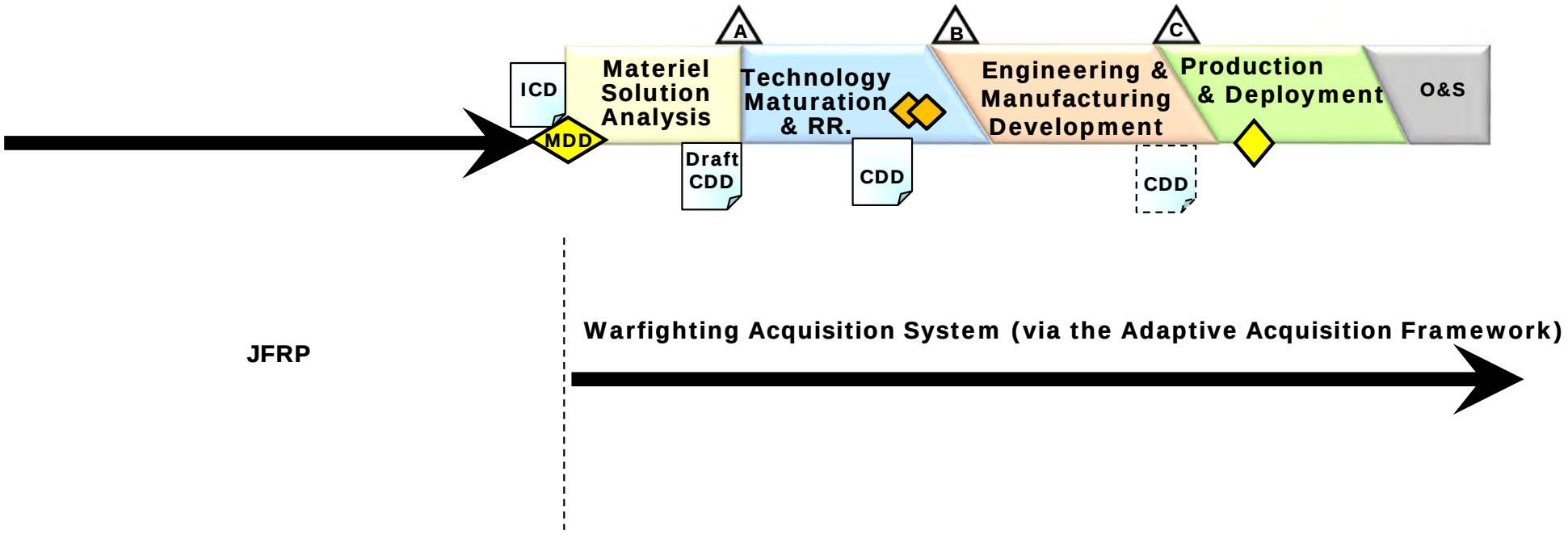
5 Core Components of JFRP

1. ***Reoriented JROC***: The JROC no longer validates most Service-specific requirements. Instead, its focus is elevated to the joint level, concentrating on 3 main areas:
   - Joint Force Design (JFD): Shaping the future Joint Force with a long-term strategic outlook
   - Joint Capability Integration (JCI): Assessing military capabilities, managing interdependencies between services, and promoting interoperability to ensure a ready and integrated Joint Force
   - Combatant Command (CCMD) Requirements: Reviewing, assessing, and prioritizing requirements from the Combatant Commands
2. ***Joint Operational Problems (JOPs)***: The JROC will now annually identify and prioritize a list of the most pressing challenges facing the Joint Force, known as JOPs. This prioritized list acts as the single authoritative "joint demand signal" that drives analysis, experimentation, and, most importantly, budgeting decisions across the DoW

5 Core Components of JFRP (cont.)

3. ***Unified Urgent Needs Process***: The former "Joint Urgent Operational Need" (JUON) and "Joint Emergent Operational Need" (JEON) pathways have been consolidated into a single, unified process called the Joint Immediate Combatant Command Requirement (JICR). This process is reserved exclusively for urgent capability gaps that, if unfulfilled, would result in "certain death and/or pose unacceptable risks to a primary objective of ongoing or imminent operations." It establishes a high threshold for entry but provides a rapid, 35-business-day assessment and approval process to field a usable capability within two years
4. ***Empowered Services***: The military Services and Components now have greater autonomy. They are responsible for generating, validating, and documenting their own specific requirements. While they no longer need JROC validation for most programs, they must share this information to ensure the JROC can maintain joint awareness and manage integration and interoperability
5. ***Direct Link to Resourcing***: The JFRP establishes a stronger and more direct link between requirements and funding. A new Requirements and Resourcing Alignment Board (RRAB) will align fiscal resources directly to the JROC-prioritized JOPs, ensuring that the DoW's most critical problems receive the necessary funding

JFRP Relationship to WAS



JFRP is the requirements generation process;
the DoW/DoN defines and validates requirements through the JFRP

Overview

- Introduction
- Establishment of JFRP
- Capability Gap Assessment
- Capability Documents
- Key Players in the Process
- Joint Requirements and Resourcing Theory of Victory

Capability Gap Assessment (CGA)

- Capability Gap Assessment (CGA) is an iterative annual process that provides the JROC with a framework for the collection, consolidation, assessment, and prioritization of risk-informed Combatant Command (CCMD) capability gaps
- Provides the CJCS with a consolidation of all the Combatant Commanders' (CCDRs') Integrated Priority Lists (IPLs) and an evaluation of the current FYDP's adequacy to satisfy the gaps therein, as well as future FYDP recommendations to satisfy the CJCS's annual reporting requirements to Congress
- The primary input to the CGA process are the CCMD IPLs
  - An IPL is a list of the CDR's highest requirements, prioritized across Service and functional lines, defining shortfalls in key programs that, in the judgement of the CCDR, adversely affect the ability of the CCDR's forces to accomplish their assigned mission
  - The IPL should consist of a prioritized list of singular, discrete capability gaps

Recommended Solution

- A CGA may recommend one of two solutions based on the identified capability need: either a materiel solution or a non-materiel solution:

- Materiel Solution
  - A new item developed or purchased to satisfy one or more capability requirements (or needs) and reduce or eliminate one or more capability gaps
  - Materiel solutions are executed in the Warfighting Acquisition System (WAS) process and are guided by validated capability requirement documents from the JFRP

- Non-materiel Solution
  - A defense acquisition program (non-developmental, modification of existing systems, or new program) that satisfies identified capability needs
  - Non-materiel solutions are usually faster and much less expensive than developing a new system
  - Changes in doctrine or updates to policy are examples of non-materiel solutions

Recommended Solution (cont.)

- The CGA can support implementation of both non-materiel and materiel solutions
- If the CGA supports a non-materiel solution, then a DOTMLPF-P Change Recommendation (DCR) is developed to implement the non-materiel solution
- If the CBA supports a materiel solution, an initial Service Requirement Documents (SRD) or Initial Capabilities Document (ICD) is developed

DOTMLPF-P: Doctrine, Organization, Training, Materiel, Leadership, Personnel, Facilities, Policy

DOTMLPF-P Change Recommendations (DCR)

- DOTMLPF-P Change Recommendations (DCRs) represent more refined requirements documents tailored toward a particular non-materiel approach for a capability solution, while capability documents represent more refined requirements documents tailored toward a particular materiel approach for a capability solution

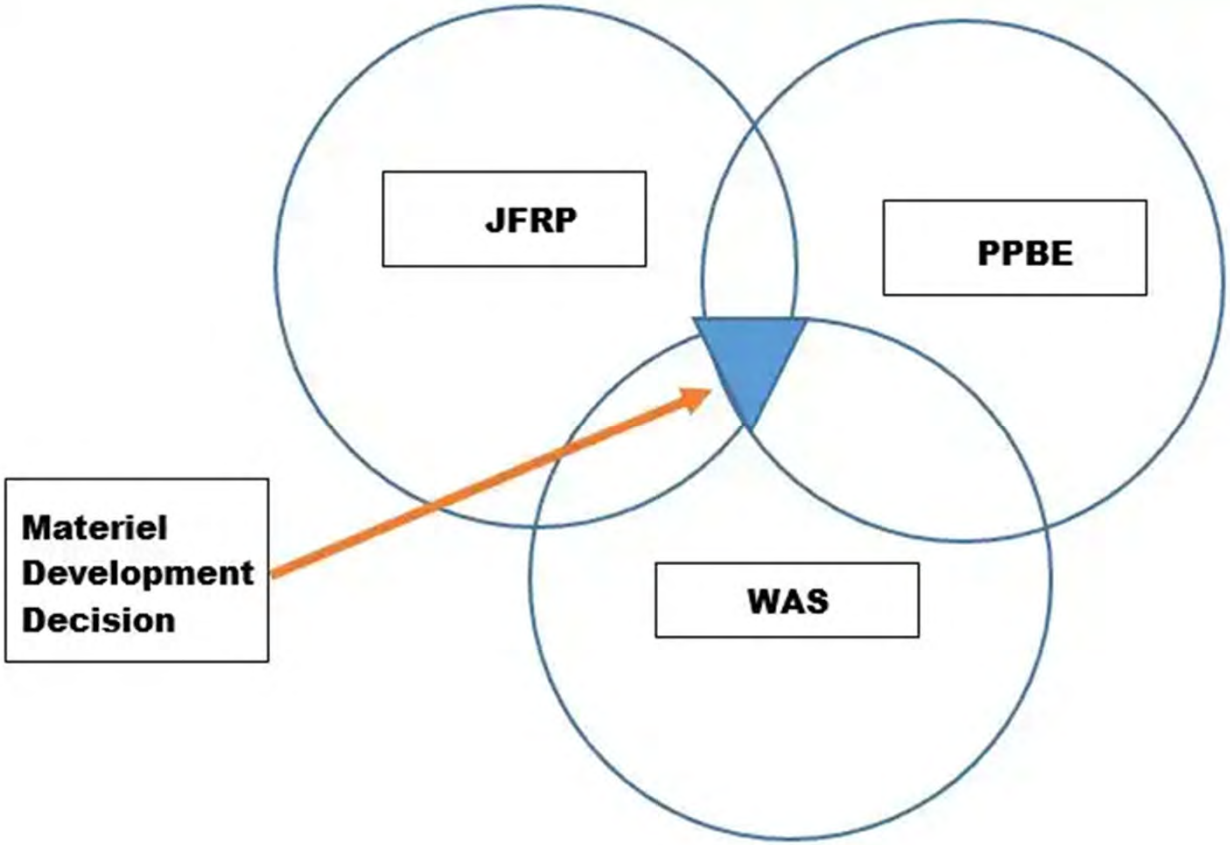
D – Doctrine [fundamental guiding principles]
O – Organization [how DoD organizes to fight]
T – Training [how DoD prepares to fight tactically]
M – Materiel [the existing equipment]
L – Leadership and education [the professional development leaders need]
P – Personnel [people needed to accomplish the mission]
F – Facilities [property, installations, and industrial facilities that support DoD forces]
P – Policy [policies that impact the conduct of military operations]

Materiel Solution Flow



The direction to proceed into the WAS is via the Materiel Development Decision (MDD)

Materiel Development Decision



The MDD is the formal review at which a capability gap is identified to require a materiel solution and, therefore, enter the WAS

Overview

- Introduction
- Establishment of JFRP
- Capability Gap Assessment
- Capability Documents
- Key Players in the Process
- Joint Requirements and Resourcing Theory of Victory

Capability Documents

- For a materiel solution, one step in the JFRP is preparing a capability document (or documents)
- Documentation developed during the JFRP provides formal communication of capability needs between the operator and the acquisition, test and evaluation, and resource management communities
- JFRP uses one (can be two) primary document(s) to articulate joint capability needs:
  - Initial Service Requirements Document (SRD) or Initial Capabilities Document (ICD)
    - Approved prior to Materiel Development Decision
    - Governing document through M/S B
  - Updated SRD or Capability Development Document (CDD)
    - May be updated more than once (e.g., JCIDS referred to Draft CDD and Final CDD)
    - Approved prior to M/S B
    - Governing document post-M/S B through M/S C
- Analysis of Alternatives (AoA) is an additional JFRP support activity performed during MSA Phase

Initial Service Requirements Document (SRD)/ Initial Capability Document (ICD)

- Initial SRD/ICD
  - Summarizes a CGA and justifies requirements to resolve a capability gap or set of capability gaps for a given timeframe to include possible solutions for the ***Materiel Solution Analysis*** and ***Technology Maturation & Risk Reduction*** acquisition phases
  - Summarizes the results of DOTMLPF-P analysis
  - Supports the Materiel Development Decision (MDD), Analysis of Alternatives (AoA), the Acquisition Strategy, and the M/S A decision
  - Can be developed by the Joint warfighter, the Joint Staff, other functional agencies, or sponsors

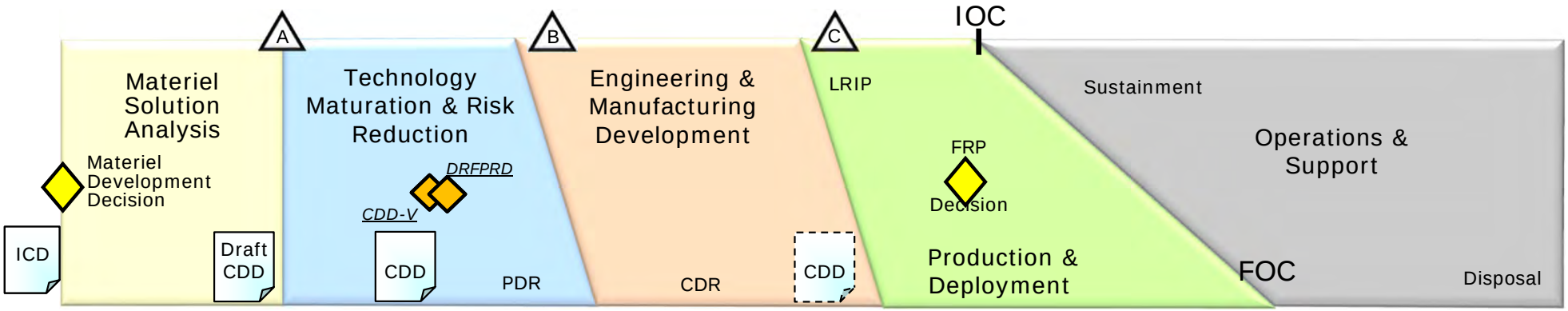
The Initial SRD (or ICD) documents a capability gap and sponsors further refinement of a materiel solution

Updated Service Requirements Document (SRD)/Capability Development Document (CDD)

- Updated SRD/Capability Development Document (CDD)
  - Defines authoritative, measurable, and testable capabilities for the ***Engineering and Manufacturing Development*** acquisition phase
  - Captures the information necessary to deliver an affordable and supportable capability within one or more increments of an acquisition strategy
  - Specifies the performance attributes, including KPPs, necessary to design a proposed system (or systems) to deliver the capability that fills the capability gaps identified in the initial SRD or ICD
  - Establishes the program technical baseline
  - Can be updated as a program nears the end of development for each increment
    - Update production attributes and quantities, system specifications, or clarify subsequent increments in an evolutionary program

The SRD or CDD is validated and approved prior to M/S B
Approval of M/S B by a Milestone Decision Authority is normally the ***formal initiation of an acquisition program***

JFRP within WAS



Initial SRD or ICD | **Updated SRD or CDD** | **Updated SRD or Updated CDD (if required)**

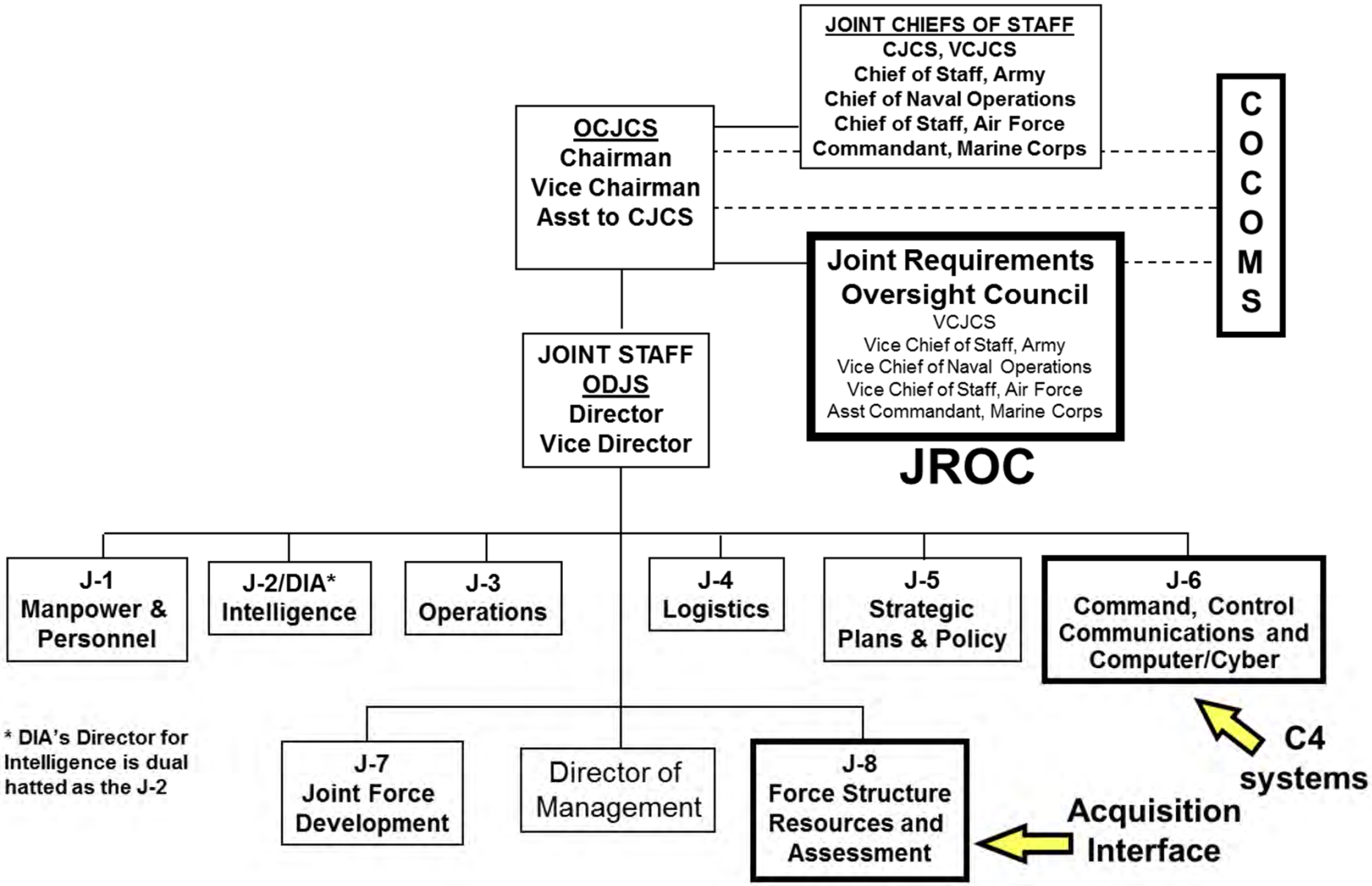
No KPPs	**Introduces KPPs**	**Refines KPPs and Performance Attributes**
Defines capability gaps (functional area, range of military operations, timeframe)	**Cost estimates**	**Refines cost estimates**
	Guides EMD phase by defining measurable & testable capabilities	**Guides Production and Deployment phase**

*Operational requirements development is a **team effort**; all stakeholders should be involved; involve the warfighter in technical requirements development*

Overview

- Introduction
- Establishment of JFRP
- Capability Gap Assessment
- Capability Documents
- Key Players in the Process
- Joint Requirements and Resourcing Theory of Victory

Key Players on Joint Staff



Joint Chiefs of Staff

- The Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff (CJCS) is the principal military adviser to the President, Secretary of War, and the National Security Council (NSC)
- The Chairman sets the agenda and presides over the Joint Chiefs of Staff (JCS) meetings
- JFRP establishes procedures that support the Chairman and Vice Chairman of the JCS and the JROC in advising the SECWAR in identifying and assessing Joint military capability needs

Joint Requirements Oversight Council (JROC)

(Established by Goldwater-Nichols Act of 1986)

- The Joint Requirements Oversight Council (JROC) is the highest level board and is the process owner for the JFRP

- Members of the JROC
  - Vice Chairman, JCS (Chair)
  - Vice Chief of Staff, Army
  - Vice Chief of Staff, Air Force
  - Vice Chief of Naval Operations
  - Vice Chief of Space Operations
  - Assistant Commandant, USMC

The Vice Squad

*JROC ensures new capabilities are conceived & developed in a **Joint warfighting context***

Importance of Interoperability

- A key aspect of the JFRP is to prioritize interoperability
- Interoperability: The ability of the systems, units, or forces to provide services to and accept services from other systems, units, or forces, and to interoperate with other U.S. Forces and Coalition partners effectively
- Importance: Non-compliance or inadequate compliance with interoperability capabilities, increases the likelihood that C4I systems will not be interoperable
  - Putting ***lives and equipment at risk***
  - ***Effective operations*** requires interoperability
  - It is ***too costly to develop stovepiped systems*** that serve limited purposes

C4I interoperability must be considered for all ***U.S. and Allied systems***

Requirements for Acquisition of Information Technology

- Interoperability capability needs are documented in the form of a Net-Ready performance attribute as a KPP or KSA and ensures achievement of interoperability for the proposed system

- Net-Ready Attributes
  - Information Technology (IT) must be able to support military operations
  - IT must be able to be entered and managed on the network
  - IT must effectively exchange information

- All systems acquired by DoD must be consistent with our official technical architecture
  - Architecture is defined by Department of Defense Architecture Framework (DoDAF)
  - DoDAF defines Operational and System architectures and encourages their re-use
  - DoDAF defines technical architecture as technical standards, implementation conventions, business rules, and criteria that govern the architecture
  - DoW's official technical architecture is DISR (DoW IT Standards Registry)
  - Architecture views are mandatory parts of a CDD – technical views must be consistent with DISR

Programs must comply with DISR

JFRP – Organizational Structure

JROC

- Joint Requirements Oversight Council
- Final approval authority of **Joint** capability requirements, prioritization, and adjudication when necessary
- **Annually ranks JOPs**
- Chaired by VCJCS, seated by "Vice Squad": Vice Chiefs of Staff of all other military branches

JCB

- Joint Capabilities Board
- Advise the JROC and adjudication of requirements, capability assessments, and documents from supporting FCBs as delegated by JROC
- **Chaired by J-8**, seated by **3-Star** Flag officers or civilian equivalents

FCB

- Functional Capabilities Boards
- 7 different Boards aligned to the Joint Capability Areas (JCAs)
- ID/prioritize JOPs, conduct Joint Force Design activities, continuously review military capabilities
- Chaired by **1 or 2-Star Flag officer**, seated by O-6s or civilian equivalents

FCB IG

- FCB **Integration Groups** (General Officer/Flag Officer & O-6 IGs)
- Initial review of joint capabilities and activities at the lowest level within their specific capability portfolio at the direction of the FCB chair
- **GO/FO chaired by J-8 Depurty Director**

Note: Changes from JCIDS process in red

JFRP Annual Process

1. The JROC identifies and prioritizes the top JOPs
   - The “Problems”
2. Develop Joint Force Design (JFD)
   - The “Joint Vision”
3. Conduct Joint Capabilities Integration (JCI)
   - Continuously review and assess military capabilities of the Services and components
   - The “Integration”
4. Capability Portfolio Management (CPM)
   - Align investments, requirements, interoperability, designs, and acquisitions of related capabilities across the DoW
   - The “Delegation”
5. Review and Respond

Overview

- Introduction
- Establishment of JFRP
- Capability Gap Assessment
- Capability Documents
- Key Players in the Process
- Joint Requirements and Resourcing Theory of Victory

Excerpt from CJCSM 5123.01A 05AUG2026

1. Joint Requirements and Resourcing Theory of Victory

a. The DoW is implementing a fundamental transformation of how it identifies operational problems, develops requirements, and delivers capabilities to warfighters. As directed by reference (c), the JFRP creates a direct path from joint warfighter needs to fielded solutions.

b. First, the JROC will be reoriented to identify and annually rank JOPs and enumerate associated Concept-Required Capabilities (CRCs). This short, focused list of JOPs becomes the single authoritative joint demand signal driving analysis, experimentation, and budgeting decisions across the DoW. The JROC focuses strategic attention on important problems that require joint solutions, while Services move at their own speed on Service-specific capabilities.

c. The Requirements and Resourcing Alignment Board (RRAB) will align fiscal resources to JROC-prioritized JOPs during the Program Budget Review (PBR) process. Reviewing the list of JOPs, the RRAB selects problems annually for deep-dive analysis and funding allocation. By exception, the RRAB may recommend modification or termination of component activities that conflict with joint priorities.

d. The Mission Engineering and Integration Activity (MEIA) will conduct mission engineering, iterative experimentation and assessments, and operational integration against the selected prioritized JOPs. The MEIA will translate JOPs into clear technical sub-components, engage industry early and continuously, and generate evidence of the effectiveness of solution elements through analysis and testing. MEIA will recommend validated solutions with evidence-based products and provide integration and interoperability support to inform RRAB resourcing decisions.

Excerpt from CJCSM 5123.01A 05AUG2026 (cont.)

e. Beginning with the fiscal year (FY) 2027 budget cycle, the Director, Cost Assessment and Program Evaluation (CAPE) will implement the Joint Acceleration Reserve (JAR) as a deliberate topline reserve created in fiscal guidance and will place funding for joint requirements solutions into Service execution lines across the Future Years Defense Program (FYDP). This dedicated funding mechanism aims to address the persistent "valley of death" problem and incentivizes cross-Service participation in joint solution development. JAR-funded lines will be internally tagged across the FYDP to ensure transparency, enable congressional buy-in, and prevent exploiting process loopholes.

f. Lastly, Services will execute with greater speed and autonomy, fielding capabilities without waiting for joint validation while sharing approved requirements documents and program data with Joint Staff and other key stakeholders to maintain joint awareness, ensure an integrated and interoperable joint force, and enable portfolio trades. This transparency ensures the Joint Staff maintains visibility for statutorily required assessments and Joint Force Development and Design (JFDD) activities without creating new review layers.

Excerpt from CJCSM 5123.01A 05AUG2026 (cont.)

g. This transformation represents more than process reform. It establishes a new operating model where strategy drives priorities, priorities drive resources, and resources drive capability delivery in a continuous, synchronized motion. The JROC identifies what matters most in the form of JOPs. Analytic products from the Joint Staff and Office of the Secretary of War (OSW) (e.g., CAPE, Office of the Under Secretary of Defense for Research and Engineering (OUSW(R&E)), Office of the Under Secretary of War for Acquisition and Sustainment (OUSW (A&S)) help inform major resourcing decisions that will deliver advantage to the future Joint Force. Clear prioritization and knowledge of future funding availability will unleash innovation and investment from industry. MEIA will proactively identify, analyze, and experiment to prove what works and drive integration and interoperability to address JOPs for the Joint Force. The RRAB ensures the most impactful solution elements get funded. Services execute at speed and own pieces of priority missions.

h. In alignment with reference (c), every element of this process must meet a simple test: are we accelerating the delivery of integrated capabilities to solve our most pressing operational problems? Organizations and processes that advance this goal will be strengthened. Those that impede it will be reformed or realigned.

i. Success occurs when the DoW routinely resolves the Joint Force's hardest operational problems with funded and interoperable capabilities within a single budget cycle. The JROC prioritizes the problems, CPM supports detailed cross-functional analysis, MEIA validates innovative solutions, the RRAB allocates the resources, and the Services field capabilities at the speed of relevance.

Summary

- What is the name of the system for institutionalizing a Joint capability need and sponsoring further evaluation of a materiel solution?
- The Capability Documents are used during which phases of acquisition?
- Which document defines capabilities and how is it transformed into a program start?

Summary

- JROC and the Joint Staff ensure new capabilities are conceived and developed in what type of context?
- The warfighter's role in identifying capability gaps is met through Combatant Commander participation in what?
- Importance of Interoperability